

September To May Is Where You Improve

Channel: Onem · Published: Sep 08, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GrzGzxiV1do> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Self-Improvement September reframes the calendar year so it starts September 1st, giving you ~8 cold, distraction-free months (242 days) to grind before 4 months of guilt-free summer — a far more effective cycle than the doomed January 1st reset.

Contents

-  Why January 1st Is a Terrible Start Date
-  Why Summer Kills Productivity
-  September 1st: The Real New Year
-  8 Months vs. 90-Day "Winter Arc" Hype
-  What One Full Cycle Actually Produced
-  How Momentum Through Christmas Works
-  The 42-Day ONM Challenge & Starting Today
-  Silent Execution vs. Viral Motivation Culture
-  The 8-Month / 4-Month Life Rhythm

Why January 1st Is a Terrible Start Date 1:46

- January 1st feels like a new year but nothing physically changes
 - Winter officially begins December 20–21st, so January 1st is deep inside winter, not the start of something new
 - You go from cold Christmas → cold New Year with no environmental shift to signal change
- The psychological cycle of a January start almost always collapses:
 - January — motivated, hitting the gym, working hard
 - February — money low, still cold, motivation dipping
 - March — still cold, frustration rising, considering quitting
 - April — spring arrives, sunny days pull you outside, beer gardens, ice cream, laziness returns
 - Result: even disciplined people lose steam by spring
- March 20–21st is still technically winter, so "spring is coming" optimism in March is premature
- "New year, new me" is described as the biggest excuse in the world — a psychological trap

☀️ Why Summer Kills Productivity 4:44

- Heat is physiologically demotivating
 - Once outdoor temperature matches internal body temperature (~37°C), you can no longer sweat efficiently to cool down — energy drains all day
 - Every degree above 25°C drops productivity by approximately **4%**
 - At peak summer temperatures, you may be roughly **half as productive** as in cool weather
- Observable real-world pattern: hot regions/states/countries are consistently less economically productive than cold ones
 - Examples cited: hot US states vs. cold states (New York vs. LA, Boston vs. Arizona), hot countries vs. cold countries
 - Spain in summer: "as soon as summer hits, you can't get anybody to do any work — I'll see you in October"
 - Middle East exceptions explained by: (1) large migrant/imported labour force, (2) pervasive air conditioning infrastructure
- Animals and insects also become docile in heat — it's biological, not a character flaw
- Summer social pressure is relentless:
 - Friend birthdays, bank holidays, barbecues, summer houses, holidays already booked
 - Unexpected bills appear
 - "Plans pop up. People invite you places. There's so many distractions."
- Summer is described as "overrated" — but also acknowledged as deserved reward time after winter work

September 1st: The Real New Year 6:40

- September 1st is declared the actual first day of the year regardless of geography
 - Even in hot climates like Spain, a cool breeze arrives in September that wasn't present in July or August — the air quality shifts
 - September 21st is the last day of summer, so from September 1st there are fewer than 3 weeks until weather falls off sharply
- Multiple societal and cultural signals all reset simultaneously in September:
 - New football season begins
 - Children return to school
 - Major blockbuster films and video game releases (e.g., new Call of Duty titles)
 - Politicians return from August recess
 - Business cycles restart
- This convergence makes September feel like a genuine "changing of the guard" — a psychological lever that January simply lacks
- The environmental shift (cooler air, shorter days, less social pull) removes distractions naturally

8 Months vs. 90-Day "Winter Arc" Hype 7:49

- Self-Improvement September = **September 1st through end of April ≈ 8 months / ~242 days**
- Summer = approximately **123 days** (4 months)
- The "Winter Arc" / "Great Lock-In" viral trend misunderstands the concept:
 - Those videos use flashy edits, Ferraris, Porsches, hype music to manufacture motivation
 - They target roughly 90 days (November–January) over a Christmas period
 - "What can you do in 90 days? That's the dumbest thing ever."
 - They generate false hope and short-term excitement with no structural reasoning
- 8 months of consistent work **compounds** — life may not be transformed immediately, but a massive body of work is laid down that pays off with a late return
- Christmas acts as a natural halfway checkpoint:
 - Work 3 months (Sep–Nov) → brief Christmas checkpoint → work 4 more months (Jan–Apr)
 - This structure is described as "you could not design a more perfect life progression"

"8 months, 4 months, 8 months, 4 months — it's poetry. It's beautiful."

What One Full Cycle Actually Produced 11:57

- The host walked through everything accomplished in one September-to-May cycle as proof of concept:
 - Purchased **Barcelona VIP stadium seats** (stadium still under construction, going live January)
 - Organised a **Cap Ferrat trip** with a new, exceptional camera operator
 - Filmed **Iceland** footage
 - Took multiple trips with girlfriend: **Marbella, Malaga, Madrid, Budva, Mkos, Bali, Tulum**
 - Started a new relationship (anniversary ~1 week after the video)
 - Installed a **pool heater**, brought in all furniture, redesigned the property, added sauna, coffee machine, sun lounges, upstairs table
 - Built a **booking system** for Barcelona VIP seats, houses and trips
 - Hired a team and worked with them for **3 months** building:
 - Full online course
 - **ONM Work, ONM Education, ONM Lifestyle** platforms
 - New website (going live the day after filming)
 - Collected **40 testimonials** from members on trips
 - Accumulated **4–5 terabytes** of footage
 - Reached personal fitness peak: **50 kg on nearly every exercise**, including 50 kg single-dumbbell RDLs in each hand
- Summary: "The business has gone from 'oh I think it's a scam' to 'f*** me, this might be the best business this industry's ever seen.'"

How Momentum Through Christmas Works [17:38](#)

- Common failure pattern without September start:
 - September: "just getting back into it"
 - October: "doing a little bit"
 - November: "nearly Christmas, taking my foot off the gas"
 - Result: January 1st cold start with zero momentum
- With a September start, you enter December with **3 months of built momentum**
 - That momentum makes it psychologically harder to quit at Christmas
 - You're more likely to maintain gym and work habits through the holiday period
 - Coming back in January feels like continuation, not a fresh start
- The 3-month then 4-month structure creates a **natural mid-point checkpoint** (~Christmas) rather than a stopping point
- Winter nights reinforce the habit loop:
 - Dark by 5–6 pm → naturally inclined to go home early, sleep well, save money, avoid clubs
 - Cold weather removes the temptation to queue outside bars until 4 am
 - "I'm not going to go out. I'm just going to go home. Get an early night. It's dark. Save money. Stay in. Work on myself."
- Apart from Christmas, winter has **zero major social distractions** vs. summer's constant interruptions

The 42-Day ONM Challenge & Starting Today [19:29](#)

- **ONM42** is a 42-day challenge inside ONM Education — designed to align with Self-Improvement September
 - If started September 1st, you'd be 1 week in by the video date with only 5 weeks remaining
 - 42 days chosen because boxers typically do 6–12 week training camps; **6 weeks is the minimum** timeframe to see real results
 - After 6 weeks of consistent effort, mindset shifts permanently: "your entire demeanour is just better, you've built all the good habits and momentum"
- Personal trainer anecdote illustrating the cost of procrastination:
 - Was told a qualification would take 6 months; dismissed it as "too long, I want money now"
 - 6 months later: "I'd be qualified now" — but didn't do it
 - 6 months after that: same regret, compounding
 - Lesson: every day you delay, the finish line moves further away — "just start today"
- The 42-day challenge builds momentum going into the deep winter period precisely when the rest of the population is thinking about Christmas indulgence

Silent Execution vs. Viral Motivation Culture [1:35](#)

- The creator explicitly distinguishes Self-Improvement September from viral copycat content:
 - Winter Arc / Great Lock-In videos use Battistas, Porsches, flashy music, sprinting-shirtless-in-cold clips
 - They manufacture temporary emotional highs that don't translate to sustained action
 - "Motivation doesn't work" — and people who leave his channel because he's "not hyped enough" prove the point
- The host practices what he preaches on discretion:
 - Just made a significant property purchase — told nobody, showed no footage
 - "You got to keep everything lowkey. You can't be too braggadocious online."
 - Runs a growing community (more followers, more money than flashier competitors) but stays silent about it
- Only a handful of public figures earn genuine respect — **Andy Frisella** cited as one, specifically for saying:
 - "It's probably going to be the hardest thing you've ever done"
 - "It's probably going to be a 10-year journey"
 - "You're going to owe people money. It's going to suck."
- "Ancelotti moment" — a phrase used to mean: calm down, breathe, stop the hype, get back to steady work
- Success is built "brick by brick" not by the "loudest guy with the lime green Lamborghini"

The 8-Month / 4-Month Life Rhythm [25:24](#)

- The core philosophy distilled to its simplest form:
 - **8 months of focused work** (September → end of April)
 - **4 months of enjoyment** (May → end of August)
 - Repeat every year for life
- Summer is not wasted — it's the reward:
 - Weekend trips already booked and paid for during winter planning
 - If it's 30°C and friends invite you out — go, you earned it
 - Taking a beautiful woman to a hotel beach weekend is justified by the months of work preceding it
- The rhythm mirrors nature, sport, and society — everything already operates on this cycle, most people just don't consciously harness it
- Rocky film analogy: when Rocky is successful he's in sunshine; when he has to improve, he's in basement gyms, running cold hills — "that's the time period where stuff gets done, everybody knows it"
- The creator commits to repeating Self-Improvement September every year until he dies: "I think it's so important. I will do this every year until I am dead."
- Final call to action: "Stop being a little [coward]. September 1st is the day for winners."